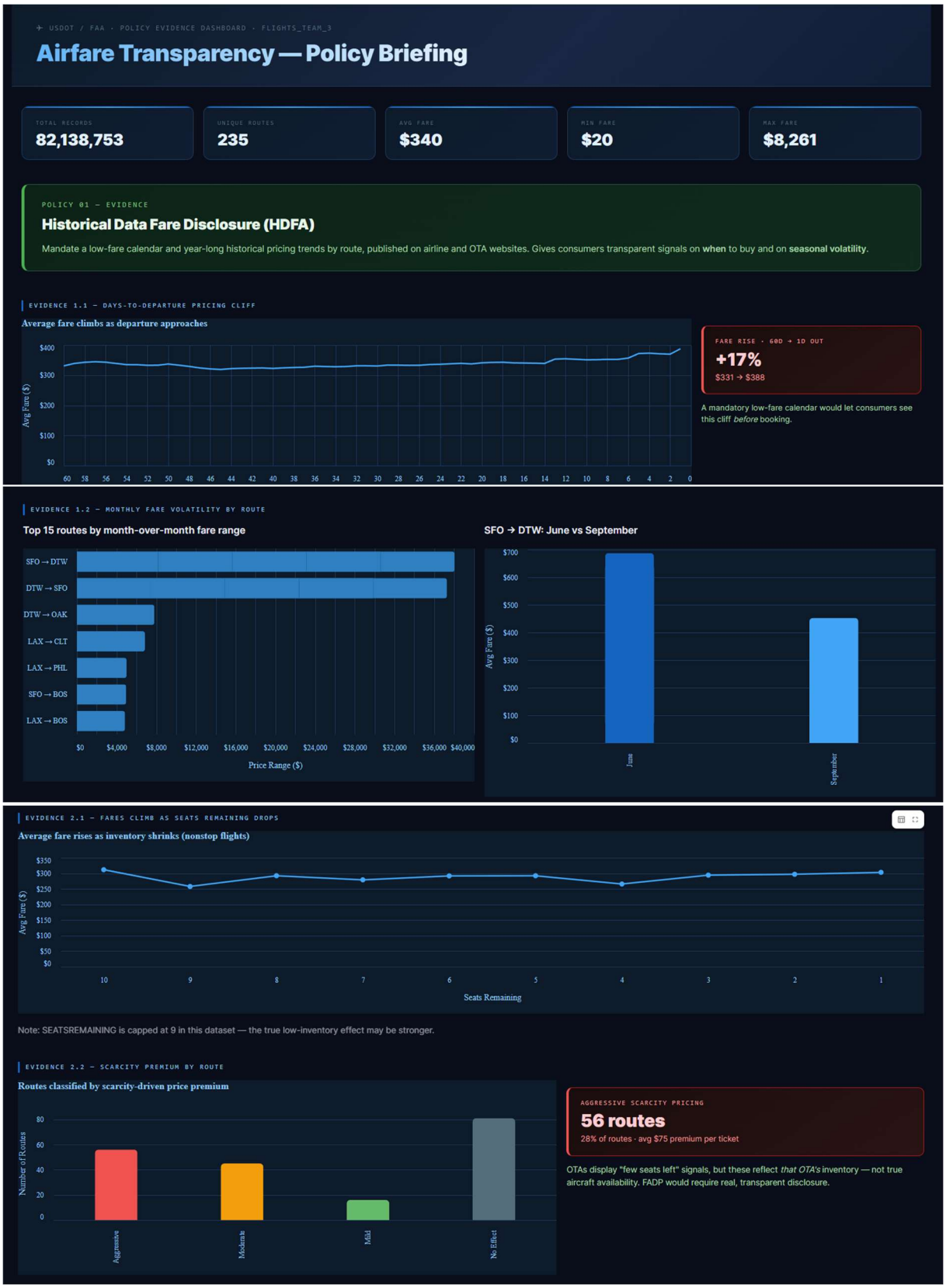
Dashboard


✈ USDOT / FAA · POLICY EVIDENCE DASHBOARD · FLIGHTS_TEAM_3
Airfare Transparency — Policy Briefing
TOTAL RECORDS
82,138,753
UNIQUE ROUTES
235
AVG FARE
$340
MIN FARE
$20
MAX FARE
$8,261
POLICY 01 — EVIDENCE
Historical Data Fare Disclosure (HDFA)
Mandate a low-fare calendar and year-long historical pricing trends by route, published on airline and OTA websites. Gives consumers transparent signals on when to buy and on seasonal volatility.
EVIDENCE 1.1 — DAYS-TO-DEPARTURE PRICING CLIFF
Average fare climbs as departure approaches
Avg Fare ($)
$400
$300
$200
$100
$0
60 58 56 54 52 50 48 46 44 42 40 38 36 34 32 30 28 26 24 22 20 18 16 14 12 10 8 6 4 2 0
FARE RISE · 60D → 1D OUT
+17%
$331 → $388
A mandatory low-fare calendar would let consumers see this cliff before booking.
EVIDENCE 1.2 — MONTHLY FARE VOLATILITY BY ROUTE
Top 15 routes by month-over-month fare range
SFO → DTW
DTW → SFO
DTW → OAK
LAX → CLT
LAX → PHL
SFO → BOS
LAX → BOS
$0 $4,000 $8,000 $12,000 $16,000 $20,000 $24,000 $28,000 $32,000 $36,000 $40,000
Price Range ($)
SFO → DTW: June vs September
Avg Fare ($)
$700
$600
$500
$400
$300
$200
$100
$0
June
September
EVIDENCE 2.1 — FARES CLIMB AS SEATS REMAINING DROPS
Average fare rises as inventory shrinks (nonstop flights)
Avg Fare ($)
$350
$300
$250
$200
$150
$100
$50
$0
10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1
Seats Remaining
Note: SEATSREMAINING is capped at 9 in this dataset — the true low-inventory effect may be stronger.
EVIDENCE 2.2 — SCARCITY PREMIUM BY ROUTE
Routes classified by scarcity-driven price premium
Number of Routes
80
60
40
20
0
Aggressive
Moderate
Mild
No Effect
AGGRESSIVE SCARCITY PRICING
56 routes
28% of routes · avg $75 premium per ticket
OTAs display "few seats left" signals, but these reflect that OTA's inventory — not true aircraft availability. FADP would require real, transparent disclosure.

S3 — LAYOVER VS DIRECT FLIGHT COMPARISON
Direct vs Layover Avg Fare — Top 15 Routes
Avg Fare ($)
$600
$500
$400
$300
$200
$100
$0
OAK → CLT
PHL → OAK
OAK → PHL
EWR → OAK
OAK → EWR
MIA → JFK
JFK → MIA
OAK → DEN
JFK → DEN
OAK → ORD
DEN → JFK
ORD → OAK
JFK → BOS
DEN → OAK
JFK → ORD
Flight Type
Direct
Layover
S4 — PRICING ANOMALIES
Share of Records by Pricing Class
Extreme pricing
Very high pricing
High pricing
Normal pricing
0 5 10 15 20 25 30 35 40 45 50 55 60 65 70 75 80 85 90 95 100
Share of Records (%)
Systematic vs Isolated Anomalies
Potentially syste…
Systematic anomaly
Isolated anomaly
0 2e+4 4e+4 6e+4 8e+4 1e+5 1.2e+5 1.4e+5
Records Affected

S5 — TICKET TYPE COMPARISON
Average Fare by Refundability, Fare Type, and Flight Type
Refundable • Not …
Non-refundable • …
Non-refundable • …
Non-refundable • …
Non-refundable • …
$0 $100 $200 $300 $400 $500 $600 $700 $800 $900 $1,000 $1,100 $1,200 $1,300
Avg Fare ($)
Refundability
Refundable
Non-refundable
S6 — DAY OF WEEK & HOUR OF DEPARTURE
Avg Fare by Day of Week
Avg Fare ($)
$400
$300
$200
$100
$0
Sun
Mon
Tue
Wed
Thu
Fri
Sat
Number of Flights by Hour of Day
Total Flights
8M
6M
4M
2M
0M
0 2 4 6 8 10 12 14 16 18 20 22 24
Hour of Day
Average Fare by Hour of Departure
Avg Fare ($)
$400
$300
$200
$100
$0
0 2 4 6 8 10 12 14 16 18 20 22 24
Hour of Day